United Nations
Educational, Scientific and
Cultural Organization

Intangible
Cultural
Heritage

Intangible cultural heritage and sustainable development

Unit 8 PowerPoint presentation

UNESCO
Intangible Cultural Heritage Section

United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization · Intangible Cultural Heritage

Exercise 1: Participants' knowledge and experience

Culture and development:
An initial discussion based around participants' knowledge and experience of culture and development, inspired by viewing a video on this topic

1 hour

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Culture in the United Nations Agenda

The Director-General of UNESCO, Irina Bokova
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- **2005** World Summit on the Millennium Development Goals (MDG)
- **2010** MDG Summit outcome document
- **2011** Resolution 66/208 Culture and development
- **2015** 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development

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2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development

Transforming our world	
3 principles	**3 + 1 dimensions**
human rights (cultural rights)	social
sustainability	environmental
equality	economic
	+ peace
17 integrated and indivisible objectives	
Recognizing cultural diversity and the contribution of cultures	

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Cultural rights

Article 5 – Cultural rights as an enabling environment for cultural diversity

- Cultural rights are an integral part of human rights, which are universal, indivisible and interdependent.
- The flourishing of creative diversity requires the full implementation of cultural rights.

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Sustainable development

‘A development which meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs’

(Brundtland Commission 1987)

A balance that is difficult to find in working towards a better future

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Culture – essential for inclusive social development

Male-child cleansing ceremony of the Lango of central northern Uganda
© Daniel Kaweesi, 2013

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Culture – essential for environmental sustainability

Hudhud chants of the Ifugao
© 2008 by J. Uñalivia/NCCA-IHC

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Culture – essential for inclusive economic development

Traditional brass and copper craft of utensil making among the Thatheras of Jandiala Guru, Penjab, Inde
© Sangeet Natak Akademi 2014

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Culture – essential for peace

Manden Charter, Mali
© DNPC

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Envisaging culture as a lever and driving force for development

Capoeira circle
© 2012 by TT Catalão / IPHAN

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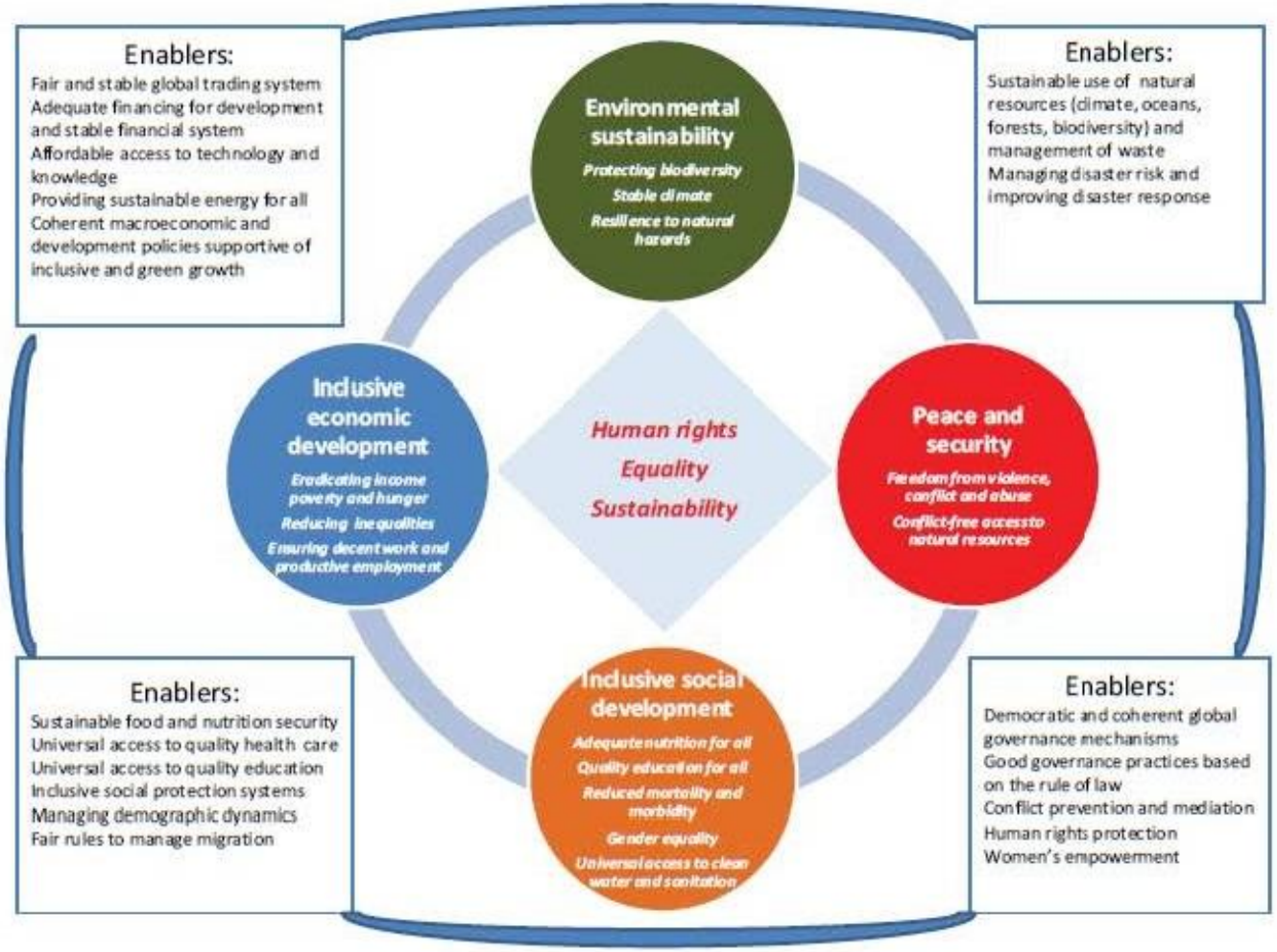
Enablers for implementing the 2030 Agenda

Recognizing cultural diversity and the contribution of cultures



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Culture in the objectives of the 2030 Agenda

1. End poverty in all its forms everywhere
2. End hunger, achieve food security, improve nutrition and promote sustainable agriculture
3. Ensure healthy lives and promote well-being for all at all ages
4. Ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all
5. Achieve gender equality and empower all women and girls
6. Ensure availability and sustainable management of water and sanitation for all
7. Ensure access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all
8. Promote sustained, inclusive and sustainable economic growth, full and productive employment and decent work for all
9. Build resilient infrastructure, promote inclusive and sustainable industrialization and foster innovation

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Culture in the objectives of the 2030 Agenda (2)

10. Reduce inequality within and among countries
11. Make cities and human settlements inclusive, safe, resilient and sustainable
12. Ensure sustainable consumption and production patterns
13. Take urgent action to combat climate change and its impacts
14. Conserve and sustainably use the oceans, seas and marine resources for sustainable development
15. Protect, restore and promote sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, etc.
16. Promote peaceful and inclusive societies for sustainable development, provide access to justice for all and build effective, accountable and inclusive institutions at all levels
17. Strengthen the means of implementation and revitalize the Global Partnership for Sustainable Development

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Culture in UNDAFs

A sharp increase in inclusion of culture in UNDAFs:

- 2006: 30% of UNDAFs
- 2012: 70% of UNDAFs

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Guarantee of sustainable development

Andean Cosmovision of the Kallawayas
© Jérôme Tubiana

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Inclusive social development: health

Andean cosmovision of the Kallawayas
© Jérôme Tubiana UNESCO

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Inclusive social development: Food security

Traditional Mexican cuisine – ancestral, ongoing community culture, the Michoacán paradigm
©2006 A. Rios / Secretaria de Turismo del Estado de Michoacán

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Inclusive economic development

La Samba de Roda of the Recôncavo of Bahia, Brazil
© Luiz Santos UNESCO

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Inclusive economic development

Cultural practices and expressions linked to the balafon of the Senufo communities of Mali, Burkina Faso
© 2012 by Direction du Patrimoine Culturel

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Peace and security – Conflict resolution

Irrigators' tribunals of the Spanish Mediterranean coast: the Council of Wise Men of the plain of Murcia and the Water Tribunal of the plain of Valencia
©2005 by Generalitat Valenciana

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Exercise 2: Examples

Analysis of ICH and sustainable development case studies

90 minutes

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Safeguarding is essential

- if communities across the world are to make the changes ‘needed to shift the world on to a sustainable path’
- if we want to find innovative, culturally sensitive solutions to the challenges posed by development
- if we want to ensure the well-being of all

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Exercise 3: Risks

Risks to the viability of intangible cultural heritage in the context of safeguarding strategies

1 hour

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Case study: textile art in Taquile (Peru) – tourism and trade

Weaving in Taquile
© Instituto Nacional de Cultura / Dante Villafuerte

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Case study: commercialization of traditional knowledge regarding *Hoodia gordonii* as an appetite suppressant (South Africa and Namibia)

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Case study: Runa Tupari tourism project (Ecuador)

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Case study: Ugandan bark cloth

Removing bark for making bark cloth
© J. K. Walusimbi

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Income-generating opportunities created by safeguarding activities

- Tourism
- Use of traditional knowledge to manage environmental resources in a sustainable way for the purpose of profit
- Use of traditional knowledge for new purposes
- Introduction of relevant products and practices from traditional medicine into the health system
- Sale of handicrafts
- ICH performances with admission fees
- Festivals
- Competitions
- Corporate sponsorship

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Risks

- ICH freezing (discontinuation)
- Loss of purpose and meaning
- Decontextualization
- Misrepresentation
- Misappropriation
- Unequal income distribution
- Overexploitation of natural resources
- Unrealistic expectations
- Lack of dialog, leading to over-involvement of institutional mechanisms
- Commercialization

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WARNING
WARNING:
Avoid over-commercialization and unsustainable tourism (OD 102)

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WARNING
WARNING:
Avoid distorting the meaning and purpose of the ICH for the communities concerned (OD 117)

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Mitigating risks with the help of...

- The participation and consent of the communities
- Capacity building
- Consultation mechanisms
- Risk evaluation and strategic solutions
- Legal frameworks for protecting the rights of communities

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A mutual relationship between safeguarding and development policies

The image of the snake that bites its own tail

> *If the world is unable to bring about truly sustainable development, ICH will remain at risk;*
> *but if ICH is not safeguarded, it will be impossible to make sustainable development a reality.*

Chapter VI of the Operational Directives, ‘Safeguarding intangible cultural heritage and sustainable development at the national level’ recently adopted.

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